STRATEGY OPTIONS / S02 / PRE-VALIDATION

PSS Acceptance 360 Business Model & Strategic Options Assessment

Comparative strategy case • commercial alternatives • decision criteria • falsification tests • evidence-to-investment hand-off

Prepared from the perspective of Research, Product & Business Development Division

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CONTROL	DOCUMENT STATUS / ACCOUNTABILITY
Document ID	PSS-A360-S02-001; successor to S03 pre-audit report, not a replacement for S03 findings
Programme authority	S04/V01 Research, Validation and Feasibility Terms of Reference (proposed, not approved)
Decision stage	Pre-validation option screening; no bank buying interviews or internal PSS audit have been completed
Prepared for	PSS Executive Management and prospective Executive Committee consideration
Study owner	Research, Product & Business Development (proposed)
Functional challenge	Technology/Operations; Legal/Compliance; CFO; CISO/Risk; Procurement; sponsoring banks - pending
Source cut-off	18 October 2026; primary public sources, existing supplied management drafts, S03
Decision enabled	Authorise evidence gathering and retain options; NOT a platform-build, production pilot or scale approval

Executive management position

Preferred hypothesis: a tightly bounded bank-paid merchant-operations and connectivity utility (Option B: Operate + Connect first). **The recommendation is conditional, not a concluded investment case.**

The competing hypotheses are that PSS Pay expansion (C), partner-led delivery (D) or no new platform (E) could produce a better risk-adjusted result. Broad Acceptance 360 (A) should remain a longer-term architecture option, not the default initial expenditure.

Evidence boundary: PSS, bank, merchant, licensing, security, pricing, architecture and implementation information has not been independently or internally validated. A scored preference is only a structured management prior.

1 Decision question and requested scope

This report addresses S02 under the proposed five-volume PSS Acceptance 360 research programme. Its task is to compare credible responses to a prospective bank merchant-acceptance service problem while respecting the S03 finding that the actual reusable PSS assets are not yet confirmed. It does not set an approved product scope, price, budget or deployment date.

1.1 Four decision rules

1. First verify the bank buyer and economic problem, then choose a product. National acceptance gaps alone do not prove demand for PSS services.
2. Do not duplicate national QR/interoperability infrastructure; negotiate lawful connections to existing rails and scheme participants.
3. Separate bank duties from PSS duties, but do not treat PSS as exempt from its own operator, PCI, privacy, operational and scheme obligations.
4. Do not invest on scores alone. Hard legal/security/commercial gates override ordinal rankings.

1.2 What should be decided at this stage

APPROVE FOR RESEARCH	DEFER UNTIL GATE	NOT AUTHORISED
Option B and C as priority research branches; D as explicit price/compliance challenger	Final product boundary, partner selection, contracting and production architecture	Capital build, merchant launch, bank fund/custody change, unapproved merchant fees
Bank discovery, merchant interviews, costs, reusable assets and licence review	CFO 36-month bank/PSS joint economics and affordability test	Assuming subsidies, QR interchange or future MDR as contractual revenue
Low-cost non-production design/demonstration plan (if separately allowed)	Live pilot only after specific approvals and controls	Representing proposed company modules as already delivered

2 Evidence brief: why an options approach is required

FACT / RECORD	DECISION IMPLICATION	STATUS
NBE presently labels its 2026-2030 national digital payments document a draft [P01].	Design for acceptance and interoperability, but do not make policy action dates, future tariffs, interchange or funds part of committed base revenue.	External primary
NBE public payment operators register identifies Premier Switch Solution S.C as licensed switch operator PSO/001/2013 [P02].	New announced POS/gateway licences need original grants, scope and conditions before regulatory claims.	External primary / gap
PSS/sector reporting announced August 2026 POS/gateway permissions and PSS Pay [P03].	PSS may possess relevant assets, but contracts, certificates, actual customers and P&L remain unverified.	Reported
PSS reported a 3DS/ACS launch in August 2025 [P04].	Protect a separate card-not-present product; do not count it as SoftPOS/QR authorisation.	Company report
EthSwitch reported 387m interoperable FY2025/26 transactions, including ~551.5k EthQR [P05].	Interoperate; do not create a competing national payment scheme or use national throughput as PSS addressable volume.	Operator report
Ethio telecom reported 440.1k telebirr merchants, 410.7k agents in FY2025/26 [P06].	Existing network density intensifies competition and partner incentives; merchant registrations are not active users.	Operator report
PCI SSC distinguishes MPoC mobile acceptance approval from general PCI DSS posture [P07].	Assess the exact supplier, software, device, scheme, acquirer and service configuration before card-on-phone pilot.	Standards primary

Interpretation: externally observed sector volume shows a relevant market environment, not quantified PSS bank demand, profitability or readiness. Source details and limitations are in Annex A.

3 Alternatives in the decision set

CODE	DEFINED OPTION	WHAT PSS WOULD SELL	BOUNDARY
A	Full Acceptance 360 launch	Multi-channel acceptance, Connect, Operate, Grow and broad merchant rollout.	Highest coordination, certification and capital exposure; not assumed feasible.

CODE	DEFINED OPTION	WHAT PSS WOULD SELL	BOUNDARY
B	Bank-paid Operate + Connect first	Bank-facing merchant status truth, reconciliations, exceptions, reporting, authorised adapters and service operations.	Acceptance channels remain bank/partner-led unless separately approved.
C	PSS Pay-led focused extension	Expand proven SoftPOS/POS processing with needed bank servicing and minimum operations features.	Dependent on eligibility, device penetration, scheme readiness and actual product unit economics.
D	Partner-led acceptance integrator	Distribute/configure an already validated acceptance/operations product; PSS handles permitted integration, service, governance.	Need procurement comparators, vendor rights, exit and risk allocation.
E	No new platform / optimised BAU	Improve current PSS Pay, switch and support processes without new acceptance business line.	Baseline that avoids incremental platform risk; may forego opportunity.

3.1 Options are genuine substitutes at the investment decision

B and C can share technical components over time, but the first committed tranche must prioritise one economic customer problem. D tests whether PSS needs to build at all. E provides the cost-of-delay and opportunity-cost benchmark. A is the upper scope boundary and may only emerge through staged proof, not as the untested default.

4 Option A: Full Acceptance 360 from day one

Commercial hypothesis. Banks will pay PSS for a comprehensive multi-channel merchant platform integrating acceptance, connectivity, merchant operations and value-added services.

- Potential value: single bank vendor and service plane; reusable rails and merchant lifecycle; coordinated bank adoption.
- Primary costs: multitenant service platform, adapters, controls, vendor licensing, acquiring enablement, field support, merchant service and expanded SLAs.
- Hard risks: assumed bank consensus; unclear existing PSS modules; technology and data scope creep; overlap with EthSwitch and bank existing offers.
- Evidence that would rehabilitate A: multiple budgeted bank commitments for a common service catalogue, verified component reuse, acceptable pooled integration cost and proven incremental margin.

Current stance: DO NOT SELECT as first funded delivery. Retain as a later architecture target only if staged modules pay for themselves.

5 Option B: Operate + Connect first

Commercial hypothesis. A bank will contract PSS for reliable merchant-level transaction outcomes, exception workflows, daily reconciliation, servicing visibility and lower bank integration burden.

- Economic buyer: head of merchant acquiring, payments operations or digital banking with identifiable budget authority; CFO procurement required.
- Potential value: lower manual reconciliation effort, faster merchant query closure, fewer unresolved exceptions, repeatable bank-specific adapters and a consistent service/observability layer.
- Minimum product: bank/merchant entitlement mapping, normalised outcome states, reconciliation file / API, exception queue with owner and age, evidence/audit trail, role-based reporting.
- Not included initially: replacement of the national switch, holding customer funds, independent KYC/credit approval, loan products, new agent network, broad merchant ERP.
- Major falsification test: banks already receive equivalent results at lower incremental cost, or cannot justify fees from avoided cost, reduced risk and merchant revenue impact.

Current stance: PREFERRED RESEARCH BASELINE, subject to signed bank buyer evidence and S03 demonstration of feasibility.

6 Option C: PSS Pay-led expansion

Commercial hypothesis. An existing PSS Pay/SoftPOS product can be deployed more widely, at lower incremental cost, into bank-sponsored segments with proven contactless-card demand.

- Potential value: faster time-to-market if production product, device compatibility, scheme acceptance and bank operations already exist.
- The lead segment must use acceptable devices and payment habits; QR-first merchants with limited NFC/card customers may not fit.
- PSS must produce active merchant cohorts, transaction approval rates, product uptime, acceptance costs, certification/attestation, net bank fees and merchant retention.
- PSS Pay must not be treated as sufficient evidence for a shared QR, wallet or bank settlement utility.

Switch-to-C trigger: Independent CFO validation shows significantly stronger attributable contribution than B; a sponsor bank contracts for expansion; and scope-specific regulatory/security clearance is obtained.

7 Option D: Partner-led integrator

Commercial hypothesis. PSS can provide bank-neutral integration and support by contracting an established vendor instead of building merchant software itself.

- Require at least two genuine commercial responses with 36-month total cost including minimums, FX exposure, support, certification, data residency, implementation and exit.
- Prove lawful subcontracting, data access, IP and source-code/escrow/continuity conditions; document liability for fraud, defects and service incidents.

- Vendor dependence can negate recurring-margin advantage; ensure no exclusive lock-in or related-party preferential procurement without approved controls.
- If supplier product lowers deployment risk and total cost without weakening service obligations, D should supersede an internal build.

Current stance: MANDATORY comparator; do not presume make is better than buy.

8 Option E: No-build / BAU optimisation

Commercial hypothesis. The best risk-adjusted choice may be to optimise existing PSS Pay, switch and gateway products while keeping capital available for higher-return services.

- Model ongoing BAU cost, planned mandatory upgrades and revenue from existing products independently of Acceptance 360.
- Consider redeploying funds to capacity, resilience, bank adapters already demanded or 3DS client growth under separate product economics.
- Choose E if no signed bank price supports incremental costs; no permitted technical model exists; or even conservative projected returns fail investment policy.

Current stance: A legitimate investment outcome, not an embarrassment or a failed research programme.

9 Comparative strategic-fit matrix

DIMENSION	A FULL	B OPERATE+CONNECT	C PAY-LED	D PARTNER	E NO BUILD
Primary buyer	Bank coalition / many	Lead acquiring bank	Card-acquiring bank	Lead bank	Existing buyers
Main customer benefit	Breadth / one vendor	Lower payment operations friction	Low-device-cost tap acceptance	Quicker feature access	Stability / no new offer
Existing asset reliance	Very broad, unverified	Switch logs, bank links (to prove)	PSS Pay (to prove)	Contracts, orchestration roles	Proven BAU only
Primary economic lever	Many fees and merchants	Bank contract + operations savings	Card acceptance volume and fees	Managed integration margin	Avoided new spend
Biggest dependency	Many banks + rail permissions	Buyer pain + PSS integration rights	Certification + device/card fit	Partner contract / lock-in	BAU competitiveness
Earliest safe test	Bank willingness-to-pay for breadth	Anonymised exceptions and bank workflow	Current PSS Pay bank cohort economics	Request for information and price	BAU cost baseline
Typical stop reason	Complexity / thin bank commitment	No bank economic benefit	Poor SoftPOS activation	Partner TCO or rights too high	Opportunity-cost worsens

10 Indicative weighted option screen — not an investment ranking

To discipline internal debate, we apply a transparent, editable ordinal screen. A score of 1 is weakest and 5 strongest against each stated management criterion. No current PSS or bank primary data have been available to support these preliminary ratings. These values are judgemental placeholders and must be replaced by reviewer-supported scores with evidence IDs before they inform a decision.

CRITERION	WEIGHT	SCORING GUIDANCE
Strategic fit with PSS	15%	Degree of credible alignment with validated core business and shareholders.
Customer value evidence	20%	Actual quantified customer pain and bank willingness to pay.
Reuse potential	15%	Confirmed assets, licences and rights available at marginal cost.
Cost / time to test	10%	Ability to falsify cheaply and without live-customer risk.
Regulatory / security tractability	15%	Clarity and likelihood of satisfying lawful permissions and standards.
Operating tractability	10%	Merchant service complexity and PSS capacity.
Scaling repeatability	5%	Portability to more banks/merchants after one sponsor.
External dependency tractability	10%	Manageability of third-party dependencies and conflicts.

For illustration only, the provisional reference weighting is 15/20/15/10/15/10/5/10 across the eight criteria. The accompanying workbook calculates candidate scores, weighted totals and three weighting sensitivities. Scores explicitly do not prove bank demand or regulatory compliance.

OPTION	SUBJECTIVE SCREEN (OUT OF 5)	STATUS	CONTROLLED RESPONSE
A — Full	2.15	Weak / unvalidated	Retain as long-run vision, prohibit broad up-front scope.
B — Operate+Connect	3.50	Highest management prior	Prioritise buyer, reconciliation and integration validation.
C — PSS Pay-led	3.30	Viable comparator	Prioritise actual SoftPOS cohorts and device/certification audits.
D — Partner-led	2.80	Procurement challenger	Seek independently priced offers and rights review.
E — No-build	2.95	Capital-protection benchmark	Recalculate against actual BAU / opportunity cost.

Displayed reference totals are weighted ordinal utilities, not probabilities, NPV, company valuations, audited readiness scores, or facts about PSS. The screen is deliberately reversible through evidence and weight changes. An options hard gate can overrule the numerical leader.

Sensitivity warning: under an alternative risk-protection weighting, the no-build option moves ahead of the development options. The ranking is not stable across all legitimate decision preferences; the committee should focus on evidence-based trade-offs rather than a single headline score.

10.1 What could reverse the ranking

CONDITION	RESULTING PRIORITY CHANGE	PROOF STANDARD
PSS Pay is production-efficient and a bank signs for expansion	Move C ahead of B	Current signed contract/pricing + Finance-verified transaction margin + legal/scheme documentation
Reconciliation problem already solved at member banks	Downgrade B	Bank process observation, exceptions/service-cost comparison and buyer rejection evidence
Partner TCO beats PSS build while obligations remain covered	Move D ahead of B/C	Comparable supplier bids and signed risk/rights assessment
No bank commits recurring fees and no positive contribution	Move E to first	Documented failed pricing tests plus independent CFO cash-flow model
At least two banks sign common modular service economics	Reconsider phased path to A	Budgeted contract commitments, repeatable adapters, signed architecture and review

11 Business model and bank economic logic

PSS should earn revenue primarily from institutional services that a bank can justify, subject to lawful tariffs, competitive procurement and actual agreements. A registered merchant who never transacts does not create guaranteed recurring PSS value unless an enforceable institution-funded service fee exists.

REVENUE MECHANISM	WHAT THE BANK WOULD PURCHASE	STATUS / NEGOTIATION CAUTION
Bank integration / adapter project	Bank acceptance/merchant operations integration and certification	Only bill where scope, rights and acceptance milestones are contracted.
Monthly minimum platform fee	Availability, standard reporting, service desk, agreed API access	Preferred fixed-cost coverage hypothesis; bank willingness and procurement unproven.
Active merchant operations fee	Reconciliation/service support per active account	Define active based on measured use, not registrations; avoid double charging.
Eligible processing fee	Actual authorised settled/captured transactions on agreed rails	Exclude speculative MDR, subsidy and future QR interchange from base case.
Premium managed services	Special SLA, dispute support, analytics for bank-approved purposes	Subject to data rights, scope and service level obligations.

11.1 Two-sided value capture

The economic buyer is the bank, not simply PSS. The bank must obtain a credible improvement in cost-to-serve, merchant retention, service quality or acquisition profitability greater than its total incremental price to PSS. PSS separately must retain enough contribution margin after vendor, integration, operational, field, cyber, certification and financing costs. Both tests are necessary.

Bank net benefit = (documented costs avoided + measurable incremental bank margin) - total PSS charges - bank implementation/operating costs.

PSS contribution = (contracted fees + authorised processing income) - direct variable processing, supplier, service and ongoing compliance costs.

No 2026 PSS contract tariffs, actual product costs, bank pricing approvals or internal financial statements have been supplied. Neither equation is currently quantified. Historical illustrative merchant financial models must not be copied into F05 unchanged.

12 Acquisition, operating and product boundaries

FUNCTION	BANK / LICENSED FINANCIAL INSTITUTION	PSS ROLE TO VERIFY	OTHER PARTY
Merchant eligibility and KYC	Accountable under applicable bank/PSP duties	Capture/configuration/workflow only if permitted	Fayda service under legal arrangement
Card acceptance / scheme	Acquirer and scheme responsibilities as contracted	Certified POS/SoftPOS/gateway processing under actual permissions	Scheme, technology vendor
EthQR / instant rails	Contracted scheme participant / bank requirements	Permitted integration + message operations, not scheme replacement	EthSwitch and participating institutions
Funds settlement & safeguarding	Bank or other specifically permitted entity as legally required	Reconciliation and reporting, no unapproved fund custody	Settlement rails / central institutions
Transaction outcome and dispute	Responsible bank decides settlement/dispute rules	Deterministic status, evidence, controlled exception workflows	Issuer, network and acquiring participants
Cyber, personal data, operator duty	Applicable bank obligations remain	Independent obligations of PSS apply to its processing/contracts	Vendors also subject to assigned duties

13 Market entry design and selection criteria

Select an initial bank and merchant segment using observed suitability instead of defaulting to the largest, most rural or easiest-to-announce geography. Target segments should have identifiable reconciliation burden, sufficient digital payment frequency, feasible merchant onboarding, sensible device/connectivity access and a sponsoring bank with budget authority.

STUDY UNIT	SAMPLE / METHOD	ACCEPTANCE EVIDENCE
Banks / economic buyers	Target 4-6 bank buyer discussions (exploratory), including decision-makers from merchant acquiring, payments operations and procurement.	Problem verified, cost baseline supplied, authorised buyer identified, competing alternatives named, price mechanism tested.
Bank transaction operations	Structured walkthroughs of exceptions, settlement, reversal and merchant support, using approved anonymised samples.	Cycle times, manual touches, data gaps, service costs and what current tools already accomplish.
Merchant cohorts	Target 30-50 selected merchant interviews/observations across at least two suitable segments; exploratory only.	Preferred payment instruments, active usage patterns, phone/device eligibility, support needs and trust barriers.
Technology supplier / vendor	Two or more comparable responses for material outsourced components where practical.	Implementation, exit, data, integration and 36-month TCO fully comparable.
Product behaviour	Controlled demonstration of existing PSS Pay/gateway/merchant services and PSS test records.	Real approval/decline/timeout/refund states, support cost, service health and product gaps.

Sample ranges are study-design targets, not survey results. They do not support population-representative forecasts without a separate probability-sampling and measurement plan.

14 Commercial validation tests and falsifiers

TEST ID	QUESTION	EVIDENCE THAT WOULD FAIL THE HYPOTHESIS
CV01	Will a bank pay for Operate + Connect?	No economic buyer commits even an indicative priced pilot/service term after cost-of-alternative review.
CV02	Are current reconciliation and exceptions costly?	Baseline shows low/immaterial unreconciled burden; PSS does not reduce error or staff time.
CV03	Is a bank adapter reusable?	Bank-by-bank builds dominate costs, rights block reuse, or variations eliminate repeatable configuration.
CV04	Can current PSS Pay create a commercial wedge?	Insufficient qualifying cards/devices/merchant use, or current product contribution is negative.
CV05	Can partner-led service beat a build?	Supplier margin, licensing, certification, FX, data or exit costs exceed feasible income.
CV06	Does merchant activity translate to bank value?	Low repeat usage and high support costs despite nominal sign-ups.
CV07	Can pricing avoid dependence on future regulation?	Revenue requires unadopted MDR, QR interchange, grant funding or merchant fee authority.
CV08	Are operator and scheme permissions achievable?	Legal/Compliance finds a material unmitigable licence/contract/certification barrier.
CV09	Can bank and PSS each show positive economics?	One counterparty has persistent negative risk-adjusted net benefit under base conservative case.
CV10	Will a smaller release prove the value?	No ethical/secure non-production test isolates the alleged benefit at reasonable cost.

15 Financial model that S02 requires F05 to deliver

5. 36 monthly rows for PSS with bank-by-bank implementation fees, contracted platform fees, eligible transaction margins, fixed costs, cohort activation, FX-linked vendor costs, certification, taxes, working capital and capital outlays.
6. Parallel bank-side baseline and with-PSS view: before/after operational costs, processing charges, acquiring contribution, dispute losses, merchant retention, migration and staff training.
7. Scenarios: no subsidy/no MDR, low bank conversion, merchant inactivity, contract delay, failed adapter reuse, vendor price increase, outage/remediation costs and currency stress.
8. Alternatives A-E on a comparable incremental NPV and liquidity basis; Option E includes true BAU investments and opportunity costs, not zero cost by fiat.

9. Decision metrics: risk-adjusted NPV, IRR if conventional cash flows permit, payback, peak funding gap, bank ROI, concentration risk and credible exit/write-off.

16 Required stage-gate conditions for S02

STAGE	PASS CONDITION	BLOCK / STOP CONDITION
Screening / no spend beyond mandate	Management endorses research alternatives and documented benchmark criteria	Option-specific governance, staff access, budget not authorised
Feasibility gate	At least one authorised bank economic buyer; legal/technical proof; Finance-owned both-side economics; independent Risk challenge	Unresolved permission, no buyer/price, unsafe funds/data/transaction controls, negative robust base case
Non-production validation	Sandbox rules, PSS Technology owner, test data approvals and measurable success/failure	Unauthorised access, scope beyond licence, untestable integration or architecture
Live pilot gate	Contracted bank, proven scheme/device configuration, approved privacy, cyber, SLA, reversals/disputes, bounded exposures and steering approval	No written approvals, uncertified scope, inappropriate customer funds/data access
Scale gate	Evidence of repeatable bank profitability, merchant usage, operational safety, resilience and positive incremental value	Single pilot success without replication or unresolved economics

17 Prioritised 60-day validation workplan

WHEN	ACTION / RESPONSIBLE TEAM	DELIVERABLE
Days 1-10	RPB&D obtains scope approval and requests buyer interviews; Technology/Legal responds to S03 blockers.	Evidence access register, bank interview roster, PSS capability attestation plan.
Days 11-20	Operations + bank sponsor document current merchant payment status, exceptions, reconciliations and service cost.	Bank before-case workflow and measurable pain-cost baseline.
Days 21-35	RPB&D tests service bundles and willingness-to-pay; PSS Pay owners disclose activation and vendor/device economics.	Bank commercial validation, PSS Pay cohort benchmark.
Days 25-45	Technology tests integration reuse non-production; Procurement obtains partner market soundings.	Adapter feasibility, vendor total-cost and independence register.
Days 40-60	Finance and Risk challenge evidence, review option sensitivity and recommend one narrowed proof.	Updated S02 scorecard, investment alternatives note and conditional next gate recommendation.

Day windows are relative to formal authorised programme commencement. No pilot or production change is implied.

18 Independent challenge and decision ownership

FUNCTION	MUST SIGN / CHALLENGE	EVIDENCE
RPB&D	Buyer needs, product scope, option comparison, contrary evidence, pricing tests	Interview records; segmentation; valid option log
Technology & Operations	Legacy asset reuse, service architecture, test feasibility, support model	System demos, topology, metrics, controls and testing
Legal & Compliance	Original licences, applicable directives, bank/vendor contracting, roles	Written opinions, conditions, restrictions, approvals
CISO / Risk	Security listing scope, privacy, fraud, operational resilience, conflicts	Controls evidence, risk register, challenge response
CFO / Finance	Pricing, direct and allocated costs, tax, FX, 36-month models, BAU	Finance-authored assumptions, sensitivity, valuation and approval ceiling
Procurement	Independent TCO comparator and fair related-party process	Supplier offers, commercial rights and conflict checks
Lead bank	Economic buyer validation and indicative scope/price	Interview confirmation; authorised preliminary term sheet
Executive Committee	Approve research and separate future investment stages	Recorded resolutions, limits, withheld or dissenting votes

19 Management recommendation and resolution for discussion

Decision 1 - Preserve options. Approve Option B as the leading hypothesis for commercial and operational validation, not as a funded build. Require C and D to remain genuinely competitive and E to remain the capital-preservation benchmark.

Decision 2 - Commission proofs. Direct Technology, Legal, CISO/Risk and Finance to answer the S03 evidence requests and submit 60-day findings, subject to a separately approved research budget and access controls.

Decision 3 - Gate investment. Require an updated S02 comparison, bank-priced evidence and Finance-owned F05 model before approving product development, vendor contracts, live pilot or scale. Record uncertainty and minority objections.

The Research, Product & Business Development Division should not self-certify strategy success. Any management decision to depart from the leading hypothesis must record reasons and the evidence that changed the comparison.

SIGN-OFF ROLE	NAME / DATE / DISSENT / STATUS
RPB&D author / manager	_____ Not yet obtained
Technology & Operations	_____ Not yet obtained
CFO / Finance	_____ Not yet obtained
Legal / Compliance	_____ Not yet obtained
CISO / Risk	_____ Not yet obtained
CEO / ExCo sponsor	_____ Not yet obtained

Annex A Source and provenance register

ID	SOURCE / PUBLICATION	USE & LIMIT
D01	User-supplied Last-Mile Acceptance Ecosystem, Volume 1 (Parts A-B7 only), 18 Oct 2026.	Prior research narrative and draft numbers, not validated PSS current state.
D02	PSS Acceptance 360 Strategic Redesign v3, 18 Oct 2026 (prior management draft).	Proposed module family / model alternatives, not a corporate strategy.
D03	S04/V01 Master Research, Validation and Feasibility TOR, 18 Oct 2026.	Programme controls, 5-option decision set and test plan; approval pending.
D04	S03 Current-State Capability and Gap Assessment v1, 18 Oct 2026.	26-area desk-based asset map and critical information requests; not technical audit.
P01	NBE - Draft NDPS 2026-2030, https://nbe.gov.et/ndps/	NBE still describes the 2026-2030 document as draft as of access date.
P02	NBE - Payment Instrument Issuers / System Operators, https://nbe.gov.et/payment-instrument-issuers-system-operators/	Public PSO register, not licence annex for PSS reported new permissions.
P03	Shega - Premier Switch Expands Into the Checkout..., 30 Aug 2026, https://www.shega.co/news/premier-switch-expands-into-the-checkout-with-po-s-gateway-license	News report of new licences and PSS business; not regulatory approval evidence.
P04	PSS - PSS and Mastercard launch 3DS/ACS, Aug 2025, https://psseth.com/?p=7053	Company launch claims only, not merchant SoftPOS certification.
P05	EthSwitch - FY2025/26 results statement (company LinkedIn), https://www.linkedin.com/posts/ethswitch-official_ethswitch-digitalpayments-financialinclusion-activity-7478784976096993282-CEh3	Company-reported comparative rail volumes, not PSS volumes.
P06	Ethio telecom - 2025/26 annual performance, https://www.ethiotelecom.et/2025-26-budget-year-annual-business-performance-report/	Company-reported merchant / agent scale, not active usage by bank.
P07	PCI SSC - MPoC Standards, https://www.pcisecuritystandards.org/standards/mobile-payments-on-cots-mpoc/	Technical programme principles; exact PSS supplier/card scheme listing still unverified.
P08	PSS - 2025 PCI DSS announcement, https://psseth.com/?p=7035	Certificate stated through 8 Jul 2026; current assessment/renewal not supplied.

Annex B Decision-log entries still required

10. Assign documentary owner to each S03 evidence blocker; record due date, document ID, access controls and affected options.
11. Interview the actual bank economic buyer (not only general product sponsors); record name/authority internally and an appropriately redacted decision summary externally.
12. Run a branch-neutral supplier/bank viability comparison; archive source bids, contradictory evidence and all CFO-adjusted assumptions.
13. Re-score all options with documented evidence confidence and three alternative weight sets; explicitly record whether the ranking changes.
14. Publish a redline against this draft as soon as internal evidence invalidates any assumption; do not silently substitute revised PSS facts.